

What You're Taking With You

The last journal. Do it at the end of the fourth week, after a sit. Plan on an hour. This is the one you'll bring to your Integration and Next-Step Session, so write it for the two of us.

Four weeks ago you started with the breath. This journal looks back over the month, in the body, and then does what I do with everyone at a completion: it asks what you're taking with you, what you're leaving behind, and what part of you you've reclaimed that you never want to lose again.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. Then, before you write anything, note the quality of mind you're starting with. Calm and clear, jumpy and agitated, dull and heavy. Write one word.

1. WHERE YOU STARTED

Go back to the first journal, What's Bringing You Here, and read what you wrote in the first days. Then close your eyes and let it land in the body. What's happening in there now, as you hear your own words from a month ago? Where, and what's the quality?

2. WHAT THE BODY LEARNED

Not what you understood. What the body can do now that it couldn't four weeks ago. Can you find the sensation faster? Stay with it longer? Feel the difference between the story and what's actually there? Write it plainly, and small is fine.

3. ONE MOMENT FROM THE MONTH

Choose one moment from the four weeks when you did the thing. You slowed the breath. You stayed thirty seconds longer. You named the trade. You said the one honest sentence. Describe it the way you'd tell me: what happened, what you did, and what it did in the body.

4. WHAT'S STILL RUNNING

And one place where the old pattern is still running you. No shame. We don't do shame here. Just name it. Which kid has the wheel there, and what is it protecting?

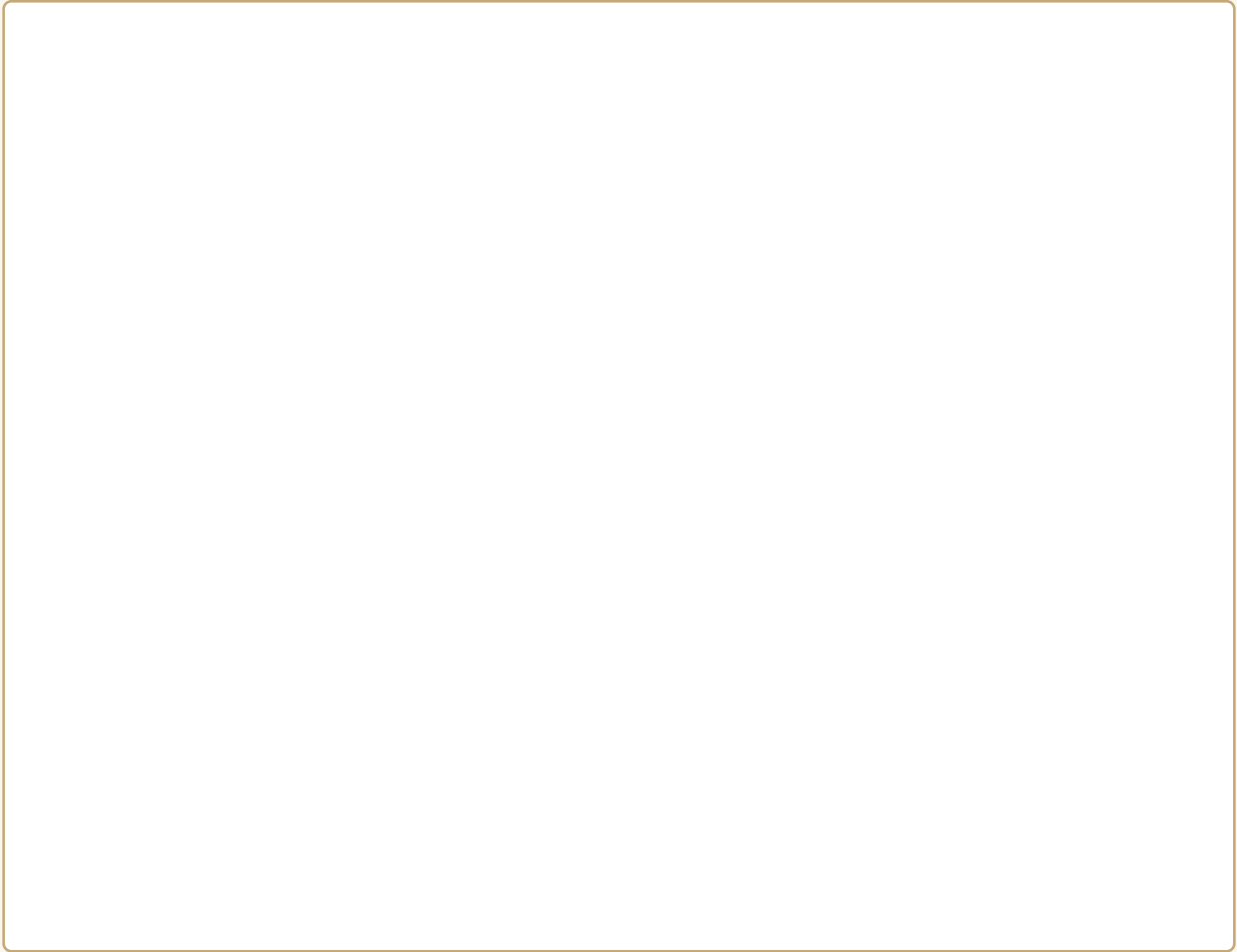
5. THE PART YOU'VE RECLAIMED

This is the question I ask everybody at a completion. What part of you have you reclaimed that you never want to lose again?

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin brown border, intended for a person to write their response to the question above.

6. THE LINE

Imagine there's a line in front of you, a white line, the line of completion. On the other side is what comes next. Before you step over it, get clear. What are you taking with you? What are you leaving behind? What are you saying yes to now, and what are you saying no to?



7. WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

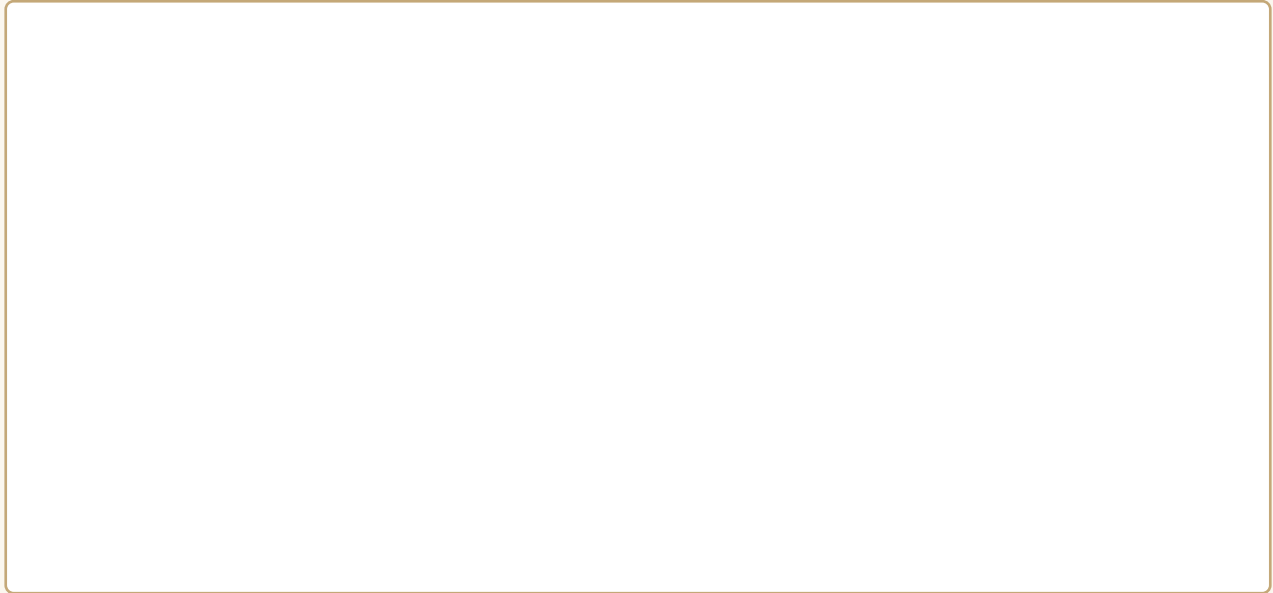
All month you've been staying with the tightness. Underneath it there's usually something more tender, the ache of the ways you had to override yourself to belong. If you've brushed it this month, write what you know about it so far. Where it lives, what it's like, how old it feels. If you haven't, write that. Either is the right answer for our hour.

8. YOUR PRACTICE GOING FORWARD

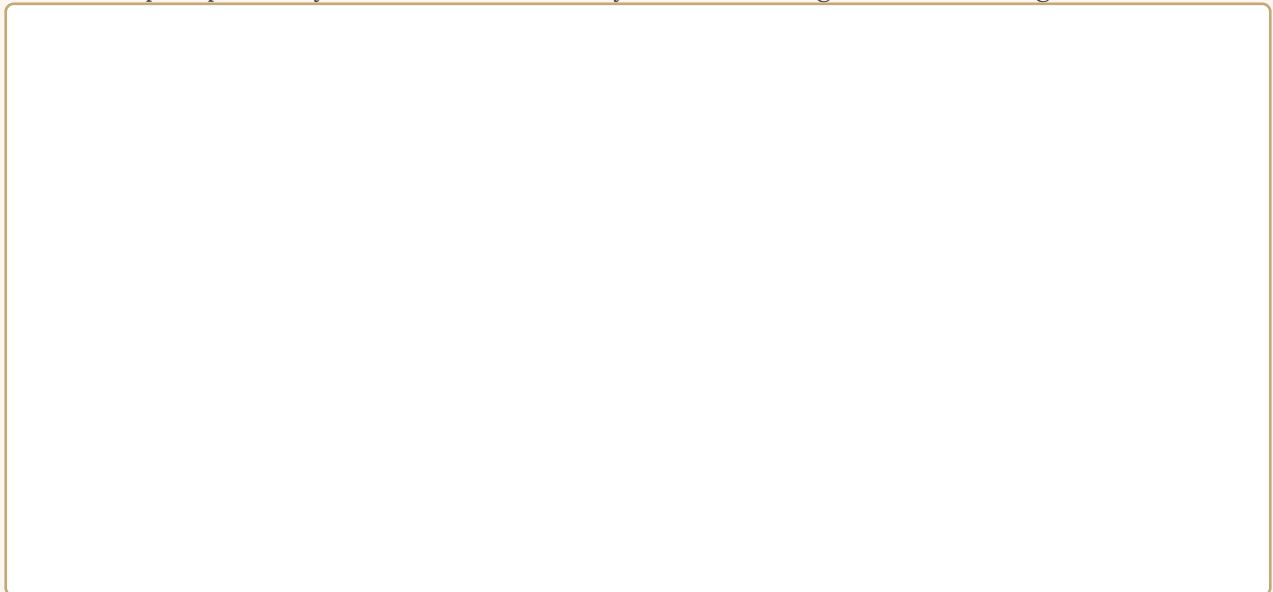
Fifteen minutes of breath a day is the practice I'd ask of anyone. What's yours going to be? When, where, which recording. And one place in your week you'll practice in the straightaways, so you know how to lean in when the curves come.

CLOSING THE MONTH

What's one thing you're taking with you from these four weeks?



What's an open question you're left with, the one you want to bring into our hour together?



Note the quality of mind you're ending with, and compare it to where you began.

